THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 12: **The Stolen Bacillus** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** tiny streaks of pink could multiply and wreck a whole city	He is thrilled by the destructive power hidden in something so small.
2	**(d)** leave politely with the tube	He covers his exit with polite words.
3	**(c)** believes he is dying for his cause	Glossary: one who suffers or is killed for his beliefs.
4	**(a)** coloured with dye and made harmless	Staining makes bacteria visible; killing makes them safe.
5	**(c)** that the visitor may have taken the tube	He feels in his pockets and rushes to the door.
6	**(b)** a defiant laugh	Defiant = scornful.
7	**(a)** to study the actual living germs in the active state	Study of disease needs the living culture.
8	**(d)** she does not know that he is talking about the missing tube	She hears only a strange shout.
9	**(a)** towards Waterloo Bridge, jostling people	He wanted to infect as many as possible.
10	**(c)** using a figure of speech, not a literal description	He is describing a culture in a tube in a vivid way.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It is the coronavirus under an electron microscope (1). We consider its effect on people, how fast it spreads and our defence against such diseases (1).	1+1
12	He calls them fools and blind fools (1) for using bombs when such a deadly thing as cholera germs is within reach (1).	1+1
13	She took his hat and light overcoat (1) and hailed a cab to look for him (1).	1+1
14	He is excited that such tiny streaks of pink can multiply (1) and devastate a whole city (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Dead, stained bacteria only show shape (1). To study disease and cure it, scientists need living germs in the active state (1). So sealed tubes of cultivation are kept in the lab (1).	1+1+1
16	No, he admits he carelessly called the culture Asiatic cholera himself (1). He chased the man to recover a stolen tube he feared was dangerous (1). He saw the joke only on hearing the Anarchist's boast in paras 29-30 (1).	1+1+1
17	Defiant means scornful (1). He thinks he has beaten the Bacteriologist (1). The laugh is ironic as he has only swallowed a harmless thing (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He is enthusiastic about his science (1). He wants to show how dangerous a tube can be (1). His vivid, rhetorical speech gives the visitor the very idea he wants (1).	1+1+1
18	It shows he has understood who the man is (1). It signals that he now knows the risk is false (1). It prepares the reader for the surprise in para 32 (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The Bacteriologist said that the slide had been stained (1). Main clause is past (1). So the subordinate clause shifts back to the past perfect (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	The Bacteriologist shows a visitor a stained slide of cholera (1). Visitor eyes a living tube and the scientist describes how it could ruin a city (1). Minnie's knock lets the visitor leave with thanks (1). The scientist finds the tube gone and chases him, hatless, with Minnie following (1). The Anarchist drinks the broken tube, but it was only a harmless blue-making culture (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The Bacteriologist believed a deadly culture was loose (1). The Anarchist believed he was escaping with cholera (1). Minnie believed her husband had gone mad (1). The cabmen were paid to hurry (1). All three beliefs were wrong or incomplete (1).	2+2+1

20	A scientist who loves his work (1). Enthusiastic, even rhetorical (1). Careless in trusting a stranger (1). Absent-minded and eccentric (1). Calm and amused at the end (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The scientist trusted a stranger too easily (1). Curiosity can turn into carelessness (1). The Anarchist's fear was based on a false belief (1). Careful handling of dangerous material is vital (1). A comic twist shows how foolish plans end (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 12: **The Stolen Bacillus** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** run hatless in slippers, shouting and waving	His wild behaviour in the street shocks her.
2	**(d)** knows the tube did not hold cholera	The truth is revealed in para 32.
3	**(a)** stared at it with intense, greedy interest	Devouring = looking at it hungrily.
4	**(c)** slightly strange in behaviour	Glossary: slightly strange.
5	**(c)** turned animals blue in patches	It had caused blue patches on monkeys.
6	**(a)** so different in nature from ordinary scientists	The contrast of their natures attracts him.
7	**(d)** fear and triumph	He fears capture but is joyful.
8	**(d)** a kitten, three puppies and a sparrow	As he lists in para 32.
9	**(b)** how one small tube could destroy a city	He is carried away by his own enthusiasm.
10	**(d)** put the germs into the city's water supply	He wanted the world to hear of him at last.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He wanted to leave without raising suspicion (1) and so he praised the 'interesting' things he had seen (1).	1+1
12	It is an exclamation of dismay at the disaster of the lost tube (1). The reader understands the colour hint only in para 32 when the blue culture is revealed (1).	1+1
13	He stared at the tube with intense, greedy interest (1). It hints that his interest in germs is not ordinary (1).	1+1
14	He felt for the tube of living cholera culture (1) after he suddenly feared the visitor had taken it (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A scientist runs in slippers, hatless, waving (1). Minnie blames his 'horrid science' (1). Her chase for a man in velveteen coat without a hat makes the scene comic (1).	1+1+1
16	The Anarchist thinks he is dying of cholera (1). The tube held a harmless bacterium that only turns things blue (1). The grand fear falls flat, which is the anticlimax (1).	1+1+1
17	The visitor said that he had wasted an hour (1). Present perfect becomes past perfect (1). Because the main verb 'said' is in the past tense (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They are people who sneered at and neglected him (1). He wants the world to hear of him at last (1). He believes the water supply plan will make him famous (1).	1+1+1
18	The Bacteriologist might have kept talking about cholera (1). The visitor would have had more time with the tube (1). The chase and its comic effect might not have happened (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Minnie said that he had gone mad (1). Present perfect changes to past perfect (1). 'Said' is past, so the other verb is moved back (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Pale, lank hair, grey eyes, haggard, nervous (1). Plan: poison the water supply (1). Wants fame after years of neglect (1). Poses as a martyr yet fails (1). The harmless result makes him comic (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The deadly tube is shown early (1). The visitor's interest is sinister (1). The missing tube sets off a chase (1). Drinking the culture is the peak of tension (1). Para 32's revelation releases it with laughter (1).	2+2+1
20	Her knock gives the visitor a chance to leave (1). She believes her husband is mad, adding humour (1). She follows him in a cab (1). She shows love and concern (1). She is a secondary character who drives the plot (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date and opening (1). Describe the visitor's visit (1). The shock of the missing tube and the chase (1). The relief and laughter (1). A resolve to be careful in future (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option

attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 12: **The Stolen Bacillus** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** must prepare the cultivation again at cost and trouble	He says 'the bother is... the trouble and expense of preparing some more'.
2	**(a)** impressive and persuasive language	He gets carried away by his own speech.
3	**(b)** make the cab go faster	He shouts 'More... if only we get away'.
4	**(c)** science fiction novels such as The Time Machine	Before You Read box: The Time Machine and The War of the Worlds.
5	**(d)** use bombs when something deadlier is within reach	He thinks bacteria are a better weapon than bombs.
6	**(a)** He put the hand holding it on the door when the cab swayed	The cab lurched and the brittle tube cracked.
7	**(b)** a disappointing or laughable ending after something serious	As the book defines it.
8	**(d)** the Bacteriologist's wife	Minnie calls through the door.
9	**(b)** wanted to make sure he did not fail	'At any rate, he would not fail.'
10	**(b)** The Bacteriologist said that those had been stained and killed.	A past main clause needs a past subordinate verb.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It is French for 'long live anarchy' (1) and he shouts it as he claims to have drunk the cholera (1).	1+1
12	He finds the man interesting and a refreshing change (1) because the visitor's nature is so different from his own (1).	1+1
13	She saw him running hatless, in slippers, gesturing wildly (1) after a stranger's cab (1).	1+1
14	They meet in Wellington Street (1) and the Anarchist walks off towards Waterloo Bridge (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He thinks he will be the first martyr to this method (1). He expects a 'filthy death' (1). He was ready to harm thousands, so the fear he faces is the result of his own plan (1).	1+1+1
16	Enthusiastic about his work (1). Trusting and careless in showing germs to a stranger (1). Absent-minded but good-humoured at the end (1).	1+1+1
17	'It' would refer to the germ as a thing (1). The writing would become less personal and less vivid (1). The 'He' makes the germ a creeping villain (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He was deep in thought about the Anarchist's escape and the truth of the tube (1). He had found out the tube was harmless (1). He did not realise Minnie thought him mad (1).	1+1+1
18	He is secretive and cunning (1). He is fanatical about fame and his cause (1). His brave pose turns comic when his plan fails (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He is swept away by his own speech (1). He says too much to a stranger (1). It nearly leads to the loss of a dangerous culture (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Greedy interest in the tube (1). Quiet excitement and cunning exit (1). Fear and triumph in the cab (1). Despair at the broken tube, then determination to drink it (1). Defiant joy on the pavement (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Introduce the situation (1). The knock and the visitor's long stay (1). The mad shout and the run in slippers (1). Hailing a cab and the chase (1). The final amusement (1).	2+2+1

20	The visitor gets what he wants but nothing happens (1). The man fearing a plague is harmless (1). The Bacteriologist is mocked for a fear that is unfounded (1). The Anarchist calls himself a martyr over a blue tint (1). Overall tone is comic (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Para 10 pictures the germ creeping into water and food (1). Such language fires the Anarchist's imagination (1). It gives the visitor his plan (1). The scientist notices only too late (1). Moral: scientists should talk responsibly (1).	2+2+1

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